

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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Theme: THE CHOICES in life of the believer **Those choices that should NOT be made.**

- ★ THERE ARE TIMES IN LIFE'S JOURNEY FOR EVERY CHRISTIAN WHERE THEY ARE FACED WITH HAVING TO MAKE A CHOICE BETWEEN WHAT IS PERMISSIBLE AND WHAT IS NOT BENEFICIAL FOR THE BELIEVER.

Choices and their implications

- ★ ALL CHOICES MADE HAVE THEIR OUTCOMES AND THE BELIEVER IS REQUIRED TO ASK WHAT WILL BE THE RESULTS FROM THOSE CHOICES MADE OR ABOUT TO BE MADE?
- ★ WILL THEY BE HELPFUL OR HARMFUL? WILL THEY BE CONSISTENT WITH GOD'S ADVICE GIVEN IN SCRIPTURE?

To accept or refuse

- ◆ There are things offered to us which are allowable but not necessarily beneficial.
- ◆ They are admissible but not helpful.
- ◆ AND in this study we are presenting the Biblical example of THOSE THINGS OFFERED FREELY THAT SHOULD NOT BE ACCEPTED. Refused – not accepted.
- ◆ Not all choices we have to make fall into the category of being either 'black and white, right or wrong. Some things are more complicated than that and require discernment and further guidance. That is why we are encouraged to go to God for his counsel.
- **SO, IN THIS REFLECTION** we will see that there were some of God's saints (believers) who made a choice to refuse taking or accepting something that was freely offered to them even when they were pressed to do so by the one making the offer.

Examples:

1. THE APOSTLE PAUL'S CHOICE – HIS REFUSAL TO CHOOSE WHAT WAS LAWFUL OR PERMISSABLE.

1 Corinthians 6:12 Everything is permissible (allowable and lawful) for me; but not all things are helpful (good for me to do, expedient and profitable when considered with other things). Everything is lawful for me, but I will not become the slave of anything or be brought under its power. AMP

1 Corinthians 6:12 "Everything is permissible for me"-but not everything is beneficial. "Everything is permissible for me"-but I will not be mastered by anything. NIV

- ★ It may have been ACCEPTABLE for Paul to do BUT it was not HELPFUL for him personally.

Lesson

- ◆ As a believer it is not always a matter of what is permissible but what is personally helpful for them.
- ◆ Every believer should be considering what affect it will have on their spiritual life and growth.
- ◆ And how will it "fit" with the mandate and commission that God has given to every believer?
- ◆ Will it be helpful in speeding me on the pathway towards fulfilling what God has already planned / ordained for me?
- ◆ This is a matter that relates to each individual believer and whether my choice will hinder or help my life?

2. ABRAHAM'S CHOICE – HIS REFUSAL TO ACCEPT ANY GIFT OR REWARD FROM THE KING OF SODOM.

★ I will not take anything from you.

Genesis 14:21-23

21 And the king of Sodom said unto Abram, Give me the persons, and take the goods to thyself.

22 And Abram said to the king of Sodom, I have lift up mine hand unto the Lord, the most high God, the possessor of heaven and earth,

23 That I will not take from a thread even to a shoelatchet, and that I will not take any thing that is thine, lest thou shouldest say, I have made Abram rich: KJV

Genesis 14:22-24

22 Abram replied to the king of Sodom, "I solemnly swear to the Lord, God Most High, Creator of heaven and earth,

23 that I will not take so much as a single thread or sandal thong from what belongs to you.

Otherwise you might say, 'I am the one who made Abram rich.' NLT

★ Some people might consider that it was legitimate (lawful) for Abraham to have accepted the reward offered to him because he and his men had risked their lives in battle for and with the King of Sodom.

★ But Abraham was very protective of the way in which he was to be blessed and prosper, because God had already made a promise and covenant with Abraham to bless and prosper him and that was the avenue or source that it MUST COME through – not through man.

3. KING DAVID'S CHOICE OF REFUSAL

In relation to a piece of land for worship.

1 Chronicles 21:23-25

23 Ornan said to David, "Take it! My lord the king may do whatever he wants. See, I give the oxen for the burnt offerings, the threshing sledges for the wood, and the wheat for the grain offering—I give it all."

24 King David answered Ornan, "No, I insist on paying the full price, for I will not take for the Lord what belongs to you or offer burnt offerings that cost me nothing."

25 So David gave Ornan 15 pounds of gold for the plot. Holman

★ IN DAVID'S CASE IT IS BECAUSE HE WAS AWARE THAT THERE WERE OTHER FACTORS THAT CAME INTO PLAY – FACTORS THAT RELATED TO THE MORAL AND SPIRITUAL VALUES THAT PERTAINED TO HIS PERSONAL RELATIONSHIP WITH GOD.

★ HE DID NOT TAKE SOMETHING JUST BECAUSE IT WAS FREE EVEN THOUGH THE GIVER WAS STRONGLY ENCOURAGING HIM TO ACCEPT IT.

And on another occasion –

4. DAVID'S CHOICE OF REFUSAL TO ACCEPT THE GIFT of king Saul's armor.

1 Samuel 17:38-39

38 And Saul armed David with his armor, and he put a helmet of brass upon his head; also he armed him with a coat of mail.

39 And David girded his sword upon his armor, and he essayed to go; for he had not proved it. And David said to Saul, I cannot go with these, for I have not proved them. And David put them off from him. Webster

★ SAUL'S ARMOR WAS DESIGNED FOR SAUL, NOT FOR DAVID.

★ SAUL'S ARMOR DIDN'T SUIT (FIT) DAVID BECAUSE HE HAD NOT PROVEN IT IN WARFARE. HE FELT UNCOMFORTABLE AND TOO RESTRICTIVE IN.

Lesson

◆ Not trying to minister / operate in someone else's armor.

◆ Often, we find ourselves trying to fill someone else's shoes in life and in ministry.

◆ We are often faced with the temptation to try and wear another person's armor into battle and that is like trying to win spiritual victories with someone else's faith.

◆ We must use our own faith. That means the measure of faith that God has given us. (Read Romans 12:5-8)

◆ Trying to be like some well-known successful person in ministry or fulfilling a family tradition- e.g. father/mother/grandfather were military men or preachers or missionaries.

◆ Sometimes this might be God's way but in many cases it has not always been beneficial and has damaged the lives of people.

◆ Let us be more discerning and seeking the wisdom of the Spirit's guidance to our hearts – asking "is this right for me to accept this gift or opportunity offered?

Amen – Ps Barry